

संस्कृतम्

My First Sanskrit Workbook

मम प्रथमा संस्कृत-अभ्यास-पुस्तिका

Beginner · Letters, words, numbers & greetings

Name / नाम: _____

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How to use this book · कथं प्रयोक्तव्यम्

1. Say each letter aloud. The grey letter shows the shape.
2. **Trace** the grey letter with a pencil, then **write** it in the empty boxes.
3. Do one page a day. Short, happy practice is best.
4. Read the transliteration (Roman letters with marks): ā is a long a, ṛ is a vowel r, ṣ and ś are two kinds of sh.
5. Try the exercises at the end, then check your answers in the answer key.

> Tip: Sanskrit is written from left to right. Most letters hang from a top line called the **śiro-rekhā** (शिरोरेखा).

Vowels · स्वराः (1)

Vowels can be said on their own.

अ	a	अ				
आ	ā	आ				
इ	i	इ				
ई	ī	ई				
उ	u	उ				
ऊ	ū	ऊ				
ऋ	ṛ	ऋ				
ॠ	ṝ	ॠ				

Vowels · स्वराः (2)

अं has anusvāra (a nasal dot); अः has visarga (a soft breath h).

ऌ	ḷ	ऌ				
ए	e	ए				
ऐ	ai	ऐ				
ओ	o	ओ				
औ	au	औ				
अं	aṃ	अं				
अः	aḥ	अः				

Consonants · व्यञ्जनानि (1)

Each consonant has a built-in “a” sound: क = k + a.

Kaṇṭhya · throat (क-वर्गः)

क	ka	क				ख	kha	ख			
ग	ga	ग				घ	gha	घ			
ङ	ṅa	ङ							

Tālavya · palate (च-वर्गः)

च	ca	च				छ	cha	छ			
ज	ja	ज				झ	jha	झ			
ञ	ña	ञ							

Mūrdhanya · roof (ट-वर्गः)

ट	ṭa	ट				ठ	ṭha	ठ			
ड	ḍa	ड				ढ	ḍha	ढ			
ण	ṇa	ण							

Consonants · व्यञ्जनानि (2)

Dantya · teeth (त-वर्गः)

त	ta	त				थ	tha	थ			
द	da	द				ध	dha	ध			
न	na	न									

Oṣṭhya · lips (प-वर्गः)

प	pa	प				फ	pha	फ			
ब	ba	ब				भ	bha	भ			
म	ma	म									

Antaḥstha · semivowels

य	ya	य				र	ra	र			
ल	la	ल				व	va	व			

Consonants · व्यञ्जनानि (3)

Ūṣman · hissing sounds

श	śa	श				ष	ṣa	ष			
स	sa	स				ह	ha	ह			

Saṃyukta · joined letters

क्ष	kṣa	क्ष				त्र	tra	त्र			
ज्ञ	jña	ज्ञ									

Vowel signs on क · मात्राः

When a vowel joins a consonant it becomes a small sign (mātrā).

Sign	Letter	Sound	Trace & write
—	क	ka	क
◌ा	का	kā	का
◌ि	कि	ki	कि
◌ी	की	kī	की
◌ु	कु	ku	कु
◌ू	कू	kū	कू
◌ृ	कृ	kṛ	कृ
◌े	के	ke	के
◌ै	कै	kai	कै
◌ो	को	ko	को
◌ौ	कौ	kau	कौ
◌ं	कं	kaṃ	कं
◌ः	कः	kaḥ	कः

My first words · मम प्रथमाः शब्दाः

Sanskrit	Sound	Meaning	Write it
गजः	gajaḥ	elephant	
अश्वः	aśvaḥ	horse	
फलम्	phalam	fruit	
जलम्	jalam	water	
पुष्पम्	puṣpam	flower	
वृक्षः	vṛkṣaḥ	tree	
सूर्यः	sūryaḥ	sun	
चन्द्रः	candraḥ	moon	
नदी	nadī	river	
गृहम्	gṛham	house	
पुस्तकम्	pustakam	book	
बालकः	bālakaḥ	boy	
बालिका	bālikā	girl	
माता	mātā	mother	
पिता	pitā	father	

Numbers 1–10 · सङ्ख्याः

Sanskrit has its own digits: ० १ २ ३ ४ ५ ६ ७ ८ ९

Digit		Word	Sound	Write it
१	1	एकम्	ekam	
२	2	द्वे	dve	
३	3	त्रीणि	trīṇi	
४	4	चत्वारि	catvāri	
५	5	पञ्च	pañca	
६	6	षट्	ṣaṭ	
७	7	सप्त	sapta	
८	8	अष्ट	aṣṭa	
९	9	नव	nava	
१०	10	दश	daśa	

These are the forms used when counting things (neuter forms).

Greetings & simple sentences · सम्भाषणम्

Sanskrit	Sound	Meaning
नमस्ते।	namaste	Hello / I bow to you.
सुप्रभातम्।	suprabhātam	Good morning.
मम नाम रामः।	mama nāma rāmaḥ	My name is Rāma.
भवतः नाम किम्?	bhavataḥ nāma kim?	What is your name? (to a boy/man)
भवत्याः नाम किम्?	bhavatyāḥ nāma kim?	What is your name? (to a girl/woman)
भवान् कथम् अस्ति?	bhavān katham asti?	How are you? (to a boy/man)
अहं कुशली।	aham kuśalī	I am well. (boy/man)
धन्यवादः।	dhanyavādaḥ	Thank you.
पुनः मिलामः।	punaḥ milāmaḥ	See you again.

Practise with a friend: say नमस्ते, ask the name, and answer मम नाम ____ ।

Exercises · अभ्यासाः

1. Match the word with its meaning

1. गजः	____	A. flower
2. जलम्	____	B. elephant
3. पुष्पम्	____	C. house
4. सूर्यः	____	D. water
5. गृहम्	____	E. sun

2. Add the vowel sign and write the letter

क + ा = ____ क + ि = ____ क + ु = ____

क + े = ____ क + ो = ____ क + ौ = ____

3. Fill in the blank (choose: नाम · नमस्ते · कुशली)

1. ____ ! (Hello)
2. मम ____ सीता। (My name is Sītā.)
3. अहं ____ । (I am well.)

Exercises · अभ्यासाः (continued)

4. Write in Devanagari

1. phalam (fruit) _____
2. nadī (river) _____
3. mātā (mother) _____
4. pañca (five) _____

5. Write the Sanskrit digit and the number word

1. 3 → ____ · _____
2. 7 → ____ · _____
3. 10 → ____ · _____

6. Circle the vowels

क इ म ऊ त ए र औ

Colours · वर्णाः

Colour	Sanskrit	Sound	Meaning	Write it
	रक्तः	raktaḥ	red	
	नीलः	nīlaḥ	blue	
	हरितः	haritaḥ	green	
	पीतः	pītaḥ	yellow	
	श्वेतः	śvetaḥ	white	
	कृष्णः	kṛṣṇaḥ	black	
	नारङ्गः	nāraṅgaḥ	orange	
	पाटलः	pāṭalaḥ	pink	

These are the masculine forms, used with a masculine word: नीलः मयूरः (a blue peacock).

My body · शरीरम्

Sanskrit	Sound	Meaning	Write it
शिरः	śiraḥ	head	
केशः	keśaḥ	hair	
नेत्रम्	netram	eye	
कर्णः	karṇaḥ	ear	
नासिका	nāsikā	nose	
मुखम्	mukham	mouth, face	
दन्तः	dantaḥ	tooth	
हस्तः	hastaḥ	hand	
अङ्गुलिः	aṅguliḥ	finger	
पादः	pādaḥ	foot	

Point and say: एतत् मम नेत्रम्। (etat mama netram: This is my eye.)

Animals & birds · पशवः पक्षिणः च

Animals · पशवः

Sanskrit	Sound	Meaning	Write it
सिंहः	siṃhaḥ	lion	
व्याघ्रः	vyāghraḥ	tiger	
धेनुः	dhenuḥ	cow	
वानरः	vānaraḥ	monkey	
मार्जारः	mārjāraḥ	cat	
कुक्कुरः	kukkuraḥ	dog	
मृगः	mṛgaḥ	deer	
सर्पः	sarpaḥ	snake	

Birds · पक्षिणः

Sanskrit	Sound	Meaning	Write it
काकः	kākaḥ	crow	
मयूरः	mayūraḥ	peacock	
शुकः	śukaḥ	parrot	
हंसः	haṃsaḥ	swan	
कपोतः	kapotaḥ	pigeon	
चटका	caṭakā	sparrow	

My family · मम कुटुम्बम्

Sanskrit	Sound	Meaning	Write it
माता	mātā	mother	
पिता	pitā	father	
भ्राता	bhrātā	brother	
भगिनी	bhaginī	sister	
पुत्रः	putraḥ	son	
पुत्री	putrī	daughter	
पितामहः	pitāmahaḥ	grandfather (father’s father)	
पितामही	pitāmahī	grandmother (father’s mother)	
मातुलः	mātulaḥ	uncle (mother’s brother)	
मित्रम्	mitram	friend	

Say: मम माता। (mama mātā: my mother) · मम मित्रम्। (mama mitram: my friend)

Days of the week · वासराः

Sanskrit	Sound	Meaning	Write it
रविवासरः	ravivāsaraḥ	Sunday	
सोमवासरः	somavāsaraḥ	Monday	
मङ्गलवासरः	maṅgalavāsaraḥ	Tuesday	
बुधवासरः	budhavāsaraḥ	Wednesday	
गुरुवासरः	guruvāsaraḥ	Thursday	
शुक्रवासरः	śukravāsaraḥ	Friday	
शनिवासरः	śanivāsaraḥ	Saturday	

Each name is a heavenly body + vāsara (day): ravi sun, soma moon, maṅgala Mars, budha Mercury, guru Jupiter, śukra Venus, śani Saturn.

Today is / अद्य _____ ।

This and that · सः सा तत्

Word	Sound	Meaning
सः	saḥ	he, that (masculine)
सा	sā	she, that (feminine)
तत्	tat	it, that (neuter)
एषः	eṣaḥ	this (masculine)
एषा	eṣā	this (feminine)
एतत्	etat	this (neuter)

Simple sentences

Sanskrit	Sound	Meaning
सः बालकः।	saḥ bālakaḥ	That is a boy.
सा बालिका।	sā bālikā	That is a girl.
तत् फलम्।	tat phalam	That is a fruit.
एषः गजः।	eṣaḥ gajaḥ	This is an elephant.
एषा नदी।	eṣā nadī	This is a river.
एतत् पुष्पम्।	etat puṣpam	This is a flower.

Here सः and एषः are written in school style, without sandhi. In careful writing they become स / एष before a consonant: स बालकः, एष गजः.

Try it: choose सः, सा or तत्

1. ____ माता। (That is mother.)
2. ____ पिता। (That is father.)
3. ____ जलम्। (That is water.)

I, you, he · अहम् त्वम् सः

Present tense (laṭ, लट्), one person. The ending changes with the person:

Person	Ending	पठ् (read)	गच्छ् (go)
अहम् (I)	-आमि	पठामि	गच्छामि
त्वम् (you)	-असि	पठसि	गच्छसि
सः / सा (he / she)	-अति	पठति	गच्छति

Sanskrit	Sound	Meaning
अहं पठामि।	ahaṃ paṭhāmi	I read.
त्वं पठसि।	tvaṃ paṭhasi	You read.
सः पठति।	saḥ paṭhati	He reads.
सा पठति।	sā paṭhati	She reads.
अहं लिखामि।	ahaṃ likhāmi	I write.
त्वं लिखसि।	tvaṃ likhasi	You write.
सः लिखति।	saḥ likhati	He writes.

Try it

1. अहं _____ । (खाद्: eat)
2. त्वं _____ । (पिब्: drink)
3. सा _____ । (गच्छ्: go)

Action words · क्रियापदानि

Sanskrit	Sound	Meaning	Write it
गच्छति	gacchati	he / she goes	
आगच्छति	āgacchati	he / she comes	
खादति	khādati	he / she eats	
पिबति	pibati	he / she drinks	
पठति	paṭhati	he / she reads	
लिखति	likhati	he / she writes	
वदति	vadati	he / she speaks	
पश्यति	paśyati	he / she sees	
क्रीडति	krīḍati	he / she plays	
धावति	dhāvati	he / she runs	
हसति	hasati	he / she laughs	
स्वपिति	svapiti	he / she sleeps	

Example: बालकः जलं पिबति। (bālakaḥ jalaṃ pibati: The boy drinks water.)

A good saying · सुभाषितम्

उद्यमेन हि सिध्यन्ति कार्याणि न मनोरथैः ।
न हि सुप्तस्य सिंहस्य प्रविशन्ति मुखे मृगाः ॥

udyamena hi sidhyanti kāryāṇi na manorathaiḥ |
na hi suptasya siṃhasya praviśanti mukhe mṛgāḥ ||

— Hitopadeśa

Word	Meaning
उद्यमेन	by effort
सिध्यन्ति	are completed
कार्याणि	tasks, works
मनोरथैः	by wishes
सुप्तस्य सिंहस्य	of a sleeping lion
प्रविशन्ति मुखे मृगाः	deer enter into the mouth

Meaning: Work gets done by effort, not by just wishing. Deer do not walk into the mouth of a sleeping lion.

Copy the first line neatly

Word search · शब्द-अन्वेषणम्

Find these 5 words. They go across (→) or down (↓). Circle each one.

नदी · माता · पिता · बालिका · नासिका

न	दी	क	मा	ता	ह
र	श	प	स	ल	बा
चा	व	टि	ता	ज	लि
ट	पि	ता	क	न	का
ना	सि	का	र	ग	भ
य	सु	र	ल	म	ध

Each box holds one syllable, for example ना, सि, का.

Review test · पुनरावृत्तिः (1)

A. Write the meaning (1 mark each)

1. सिंहः _____
2. नेत्रम् _____
3. भगिनी _____
4. पीतः _____
5. सोमवासरः _____

B. Write in Sanskrit (1 mark each)

6. crow _____
7. hand _____
8. friend _____
9. green _____
10. Sunday _____

Review test · पुनरावृत्तिः (2)

C. Fill in the verb (1 mark each)

11. अहं पुस्तकं _____ । (पठ्: read)
12. त्वं जलं _____ । (पिब्: drink)
13. सः फलं _____ । (खाद्: eat)

D. Choose सः, सा or तत् (1 mark each)

14. ____ बालिका।
15. ____ पुष्पम्।
16. ____ वानरः।

E. Number words (1 mark each)

17. ४ → _____
18. ९ → _____

F. Complete the saying (2 marks)

उद्यमेन हि सिध्यन्ति कार्याणि न _____ ।

> My score: _____ / 20

Certificate · प्रमाणपत्रम्

This is to certify that

_____

has finished **My First Sanskrit Workbook**
and can read and write the Sanskrit letters, first words, numbers and greetings.

शोभनम्! अग्रे गच्छ।

Well done! Keep going.

Date / दिनाङ्कः _____

Teacher / Parent _____

Answer key · उत्तराणि (1)

Exercises (pages 12–13)

1. 1-B, 2-D, 3-A, 4-E, 5-C
2. का, कि, कु, के, को, कौ
3. (1) नमस्ते (2) नाम (3) कुशली
4. फलम्, नदी, माता, पञ्च
5. ३ · त्रीणि; ७ · सप्त; १० · दश
6. Vowels: इ, ऊ, ए, औ

This and that

सा माता। · सः पिता। · तत् जलम्।

I, you, he

अहं खादामि। · त्वं पिबसि। · सा गच्छति।

Word search

न	दी	क	मा	ता	ह
र	श	प	स	ल	बा
चा	व	टि	ता	ज	लि
ट	पि	ता	क	न	का
ना	सि	का	र	ग	भ
य	सु	र	ल	म	ध

नदी and माता: row 1 across · पिता: [illegible] across · नासिका: row 5 across · बालिका: last column down.

Answer key · उत्तराणि (2)

Review test

1. lion
2. eye
3. sister
4. yellow
5. Monday
6. काकः
7. हस्तः
8. मित्रम्
9. हरितः
10. रविवासरः
11. पठामि
12. पिबसि
13. खादति
14. सा
15. तत्
16. सः
17. चत्वारि
18. नव
19. मनोरथैः (2 marks)

शोभनम्! Well done! Now fill in your certificate.